



Welcome To The Finder

The Finder is a special IIGS Desktop program for manipulating your disks, programs, and documents. It's included with the IIGS System Software, and it's the first program most IIGS users learn how to operate. When you boot your System Disk (or the hard drive on which you've installed System 6) and the red bar has finished filling the thermometer, the Finder is normally the first program that appears on your screen.

The Finder has most of the same functions as other Desktop programs, except that these functions work directly on the contents of your disks instead of, for example, on word processing documents. The Finder allows you to:

- Initialize new disks and erase existing ones for reuse
- View your disks' contents and organize files into folders
- Move files from one folder to another
- Copy files from one disk to another
- Rename, lock and unlock, and delete files
- Display information about your disks and files
- Perform routine verification of disks and files
- Launch programs and open documents

We've already seen many of the Finder's menus and dialogs as examples in the previous chapter. And since the Finder is a Desktop program, you only need to learn the features specific to the Finder, not the features all Desktop programs have in common—and you'll find other desktop programs equally easy to learn. Boot up the Finder and follow along.

The Icons

The Finder displays icons (small pictures) to represent the disks and devices you can work with. Figure 6A is a "disktionary" of the disk icons you'll see in the Finder. The icons are arrayed along the right side of the Finder screen, starting at the top. There's also a special icon called the Trash in the lower right corner, which you'll use when you want to get rid of something. Each icon is labeled with a "name tag" to identify the disk. (If any of the disks are write-protected—in other words, if the notch is covered on a 5.25" disk or the window in the corner of a 3.5" disk is open—a small padlock symbol appears to the left of the disk's name.)